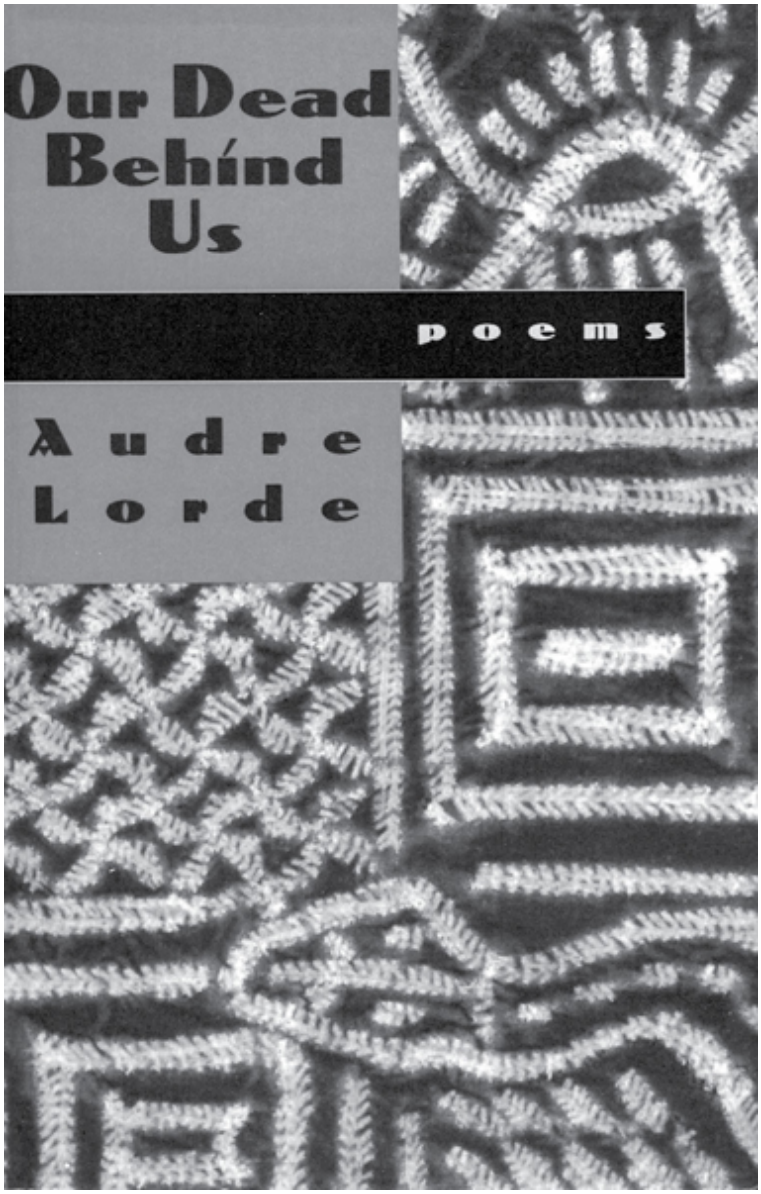


FIGURE 4.3 Cover, Audre Lorde, *Our Dead Behind Us*, 1986. (Norton)

Lorde's creative methodology for writing poetry sheds light on her own previously stated theoretical formulation that poetry is an imaginative form of historical record and intervention. Lorde's primary identification as a poet did not preclude her pursuing multiple genres of political and critical writing or engaging in nonpoetic forms to deal with the political potential of poetry and reckon with structures and sites of division.[11] Consider her critical assertion in "Poetry Is Not a Luxury" (1977) that poetry is the "skeleton architecture" that forges "a bridge across our fears of what has never been before," in which she conveys a connection between poetics and political